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Method and system for improving enriching experiences

Abstract

Methods and systems for improving and incentivizing a user to engage in enriching experiences are provided. In some examples, the methods and systems include at least one enriching program, where the at least one enriching program provides for a user to engage in an enriching activity by preventing access to a list of preselected content. In some examples, a user may engage in addition enriching experiences to earn a physical item selected from a register of physical items provided by one or more third parties.

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Background/Summary

CLAIM OF PRIORITY (1) This application is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/182,973 filed on Mar. 13, 2023, entitled "METHOD AND SYSTEM FOR IMPROVING COUPLING AND COHESION OF AT LEAST ONE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM", which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/930,670 filed on Sep. 8, 2022, entitled "METHOD AND SYSTEM FOR IMPROVING COUPLING AND COHESION OF AT LEAST ONE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM", and also claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/176,239 filed on Feb. 28, 2023, entitled "METHOD AND SYSTEM FOR IMPROVING COUPLING AND COHESION OF AT LEAST ONE EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM" the contents of all of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

FIELD
(1) The field of the present disclosure relates to a method and system for improving enriching experiences.
INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE
(2) The disclosure of United States Patent Application Publication No. 2018/0315332 is incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.
BACKGROUND OF TECHNICAL PROBLEM
(3) Enrichment programs can be used to limit the amount of time that a user of an internet enabled electronic device (such as, but not limited to a smartphone) can spend on non-enriching tasks.
(4) However, enrichment programs may interact with an application programming interface (API) of the internet enabled electronic device. An issue that arises with such a configuration is that the enrichment program must run in the background even when the device is not in a restricted state. This can cause issues with the operation of the device (e.g., sluggishness or crashing).
(5) Accordingly, improvements in the API configurations of enrichment programs running on internet enabled electronic devices are needed.
SUMMARY OF TECHNICAL SOLUTIONS
(6) Embodiments of the present disclosure may include a method and system of improving coupling and cohesion of at least one enrichment program. An exemplary method may include obtaining a obtaining a system comprising a remote source and an internet enabled electronic device. Embodiments may also include downloading, to the internet enabled electronic device, from the remote source, at least one enriching program and a restriction mediation module, where the restriction mediation module is configured to transform the internet enabled electronic device between a restricted state and an unrestricted state by sending a lock instruction and an unlock instruction, respectively, to an operating system install on the internet enabled electronic device.
(7) In some embodiments, the method also includes manually preselecting a list of restricted content, by a user of the internet enabled electronic device, where the restricted content is content that is ordinarily accessible by the user of the internet enabled electronic device. Embodiments may also include initiating a transformation, by a user utilizing the restriction mediation module, of the internet enabled electronic device into a restricted state. In various embodiments, this step

comprising selecting at least one enriching experience, embodied by the enriching program, to be performed by the user, obtaining a set of rules associated with the user, where the set of rules comprises a preset enrichment quota and an enrichment count for the user, the enrichment count having no limit, and transforming the internet enabled electronic device to the restricted state, whereby the list of restricted content is not accessible to the user.

(8) In some embodiments, the method includes generating, by the internet enabled electronic device the at least one enriching experience and raising the enrichment count, upon completion of the at least one enriching program. Preferably, these steps are repeated until the enrichment count is greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota and once the enrichment count is greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota, transforming, via an unlock instruction sent from the restriction mediation module, the enabled electronic device to the unrestricted state, such that the user is granted access to the restricted content, for the predetermined amount of time.

(9) In some embodiments, the at least one enriching experience comprises a timer, where the timer is configured to measure a predetermined amount of time where the user is granted access to the restricted content. In some embodiments, the remote source comprises at least one server computer, where the internet enabled electronic device is a client device of the at least one server computer. Embodiments may also include the internet enabled electronic device being a smartphone, a tablet, a gaming device, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, or any combination thereof.

(10) In various embodiments, the method also includes the step of providing a register of a plurality of physical items, where each physical item having a respective item value and defining a ratio of enrichment count to the item value for each of the plurality of physical items. In these embodiments, a user may reduce the enrichment count by an amount equal to the item value of one or more of the plurality of physical items based on the ratio which results in the one or more plurality of physical items being provided to the user. Preferably, each of these physical items is provided exclusively by one or more third parties.

(11) Embodiments may also include downloading, to the internet enabled electronic device, from the remote source, at least one enrichment program, where the at least one enrichment program may include a first application programming interface (API), where the first API may be associated with the at least one enrichment program. In some embodiments, the unrestricted state may include the first API of the enrichment program partially decoupled from a second API.

(12) In some embodiments, while partially decoupled, the second API runs freely from the first API except for at least one coupled component. In some embodiments, the second API may be associated with an operating system of the internet enabled electronic device. In some embodiments, the first API may be partially decoupled from the second API upon the first API sending at least one unlock instruction from the first API to the second API.

(13) In some embodiments, the unlock instruction commands the second API to allow a user of the internet enabled electronic device to access restricted content for a predetermined amount of time. In certain examples, the restricted content may be content that may be ordinarily accessible by the user of the internet enabled electronic device.

(14) Embodiments may also include manually preselecting a list of restricted content, where the manually preselecting may be performed, via the first API, by a second user of the internet enabled electronic device. Embodiments may also include transforming, via the first API, the internet enabled electronic device into a restricted state, such that the first user may be prevented from accessing the restricted content.

(15) In some embodiments, the restricted state may include the first API of the enrichment program coupled to the second API. In some embodiments, while coupled, the second API runs cohesively with the first API. In some embodiments, the first API may be coupled to the second API upon the first API sending at least one lock instruction to the second API.

(16) In some embodiments, the at least one lock instruction commands the second API to prevent access to the restricted content. Embodiments may also include obtaining a set of rules associated

with the user, where the set of rules may include a preset enrichment quota and an enrichment count for the user, the enrichment count having no limit.
(17) Embodiments may also include generating, via the first API, the at least one enrichment program that can be played by the user to raise the enrichment count. Embodiments may also include applying the set of rules to determine whether the enrichment count may be lower than the preset enrichment quota. Embodiments may also include raising the enrichment count, upon completion of the at least one enrichment program.
(18) Embodiments may also include repeating the applying and raising until the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota. Embodiments may also include once the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota, reverting, via the at least one unlock instruction, the internet enabled electronic device to the unrestricted state, such that the user may be granted access to the restricted content, for the predetermined amount of time.
(19) Covered embodiments are defined by the claims, not this summary. This summary is a high-level overview of various aspects and introduces some of the concepts that are further described in the Detailed Description section below. This summary is not intended to identify key or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used in isolation to determine the scope of the claimed subject matter. The subject matter should be understood by reference to appropriate portions of the entire specification, any or all drawings, and each claim.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES
(1) FIG. **1** is a flowchart illustrating a method, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.
(2) FIG. **2** is a flowchart extending from FIG. **1** and further illustrating the method, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure.
(3) Some embodiments of the disclosure are herein described, by way of example only, with reference to the accompanying drawings. With specific reference now to the drawings in detail, it is stressed that the embodiments shown are by way of example and for purposes of illustrative discussion of embodiments of the disclosure. In this regard, the description taken with the drawings makes apparent to those skilled in the art how embodiments of the disclosure may be practiced.
DETAILED DESCRIPTION
(4) Embodiments of the present disclosure may include a method and system of improving coupling and cohesion of at least one enrichment program.
(5) As used in the present disclosure, “coupling” and other like terms (e.g., “coupled) refer to the degree of interdependence between operating system components (such as, but not limited to application programming interfaces (APIs)). An operating system component is “coupled” to another component when both components must work together to perform at least one specific task. An operating system component is “decoupled” to another component when components do not work together to perform at least one specific task.
(6) An operating system component is “partially decoupled” when all but a subset of subcomponents to work together to perform a specific task. Unexpectedly, when operating systems according to some embodiments of the present disclosure are partially decoupled while in the unrestricted state, such that a subset of components of the first API are permitted to run in the background, the at least one enrichment program may run more smoothly and be less likely to crash. This may be because the memory load is more distributed over time. In some examples, there may be advantages to selecting a timer as the coupled component, as this may have the additional benefit of measuring the enrichment time, as discussed further below.
(7) “Cohesion” or other like terms (e.g., “cohesive,” “cohesively”) refer to the degree to which

components of an operating system (such as, but not limited to APIs) operate as a single unit. Operating system components operate "cohesively" when both components operate as a single component while performing the specific task.

(8) An "enrichment program" is any program that restricts the usage of an interne enabled electronic device unless the user of the device has performed a predetermined set of enriching tasks. In some examples, the program is a software program, a mobile application, a program on a computer readable medium, a cloud-based program, or any combination thereof. In some embodiments, the enriching tasks may comprise educational videos, educational graphics, educational texts such as books or journal articles, test-prep tools, study tools, math problems, games, puzzle games, quiz games, reading games, reading prompts, any other educational component, or any combination thereof.

(9) In various embodiments, the "restriction mediation module" is comprised of the first API and/or the second API, in accordance with the present disclosure.

(10) In some embodiments, the enriching or enrichment tasks include other self-improvement related tasks, such as running, walking, biking, swimming, jumping rope, hiking, dancing, taking a Pilates class, strength training, weight training, yoga, meditation, self-care, memory-improving activities, tracking caloric intake, following a meal plan, tracking exercise, bible study, cooking, meal preparation, listening to music, watching a motivational video, listening to a podcast, engaging with the community, writing, journaling, drawing, learning an instrument, photography, sewing, painting, organizing, cleaning, taking steps to address addiction, managing finances, traveling, teaching others, volunteering, and engaging with a pet or other animal.

(11) In these embodiments, various ways of measuring the enrichment count can be employed. For tasks that involve exercise, things such as distance, time, daily frequency, weekly frequency, monthly frequency, or user-set frequency could be tracked to raise the user's enrichment count. Additionally, hitting certain preset milestones can also be used to raise the user's enrichment count. For all of the tasks listed above, time and frequency can be tracked and assigned a certain value to raise the user's enrichment count by. This tracking can be done natively within the system and method in accordance with the present disclosure, or can be tracked by a third-party software application which is coupled to the system and method in accordance with the present disclosure.

(12) An exemplary method may include obtaining a system. In some examples the system may include a remote source and an internet enabled electronic device. The internet enabled electronic device may comprise a computer, a smartphone, a tablet, a laptop, a desktop, any other internet-enabled device, or any combination thereof.

(13) In certain examples the internet enabled electronic device may initially be in an unrestricted state. As used herein, an "unrestricted state" is a state where a first API is partially decoupled from a second API, allowing access to all ordinarily accessible content on the internet enabled electronic device. In some examples, the first API is associated with at least one enrichment program. In some embodiments, the second API may be associated with the operating system of the internet enabled electronic device. In some examples, the second API is an Android™ API, an Apple™ Screentime API, or any combination thereof. Embodiments exist where both he first API and the second API run on the same internet enabled electronic device and comprise the restriction mediation module in accordance with the present disclosure. In some examples, while partially decoupled, the second API runs freely from the first API except for at least one coupled component. In some embodiments, in the unrestricted state, the at least one coupled component of the second API comprises a timer, where the timer may be configured to measure the predetermined amount of time where the user may be granted access to certain restricted content. In some embodiments, the first API may be partially decoupled from the second API upon the first API sending at least one unlock instruction from the first API to the second API. In some embodiments, the unlock instruction commands the second API to allow a user of the internet enabled electronic device to access restricted content for a predetermined amount of time.

(14) As used herein, “restricted content” may be content that may be ordinarily accessible by the user of the internet enabled electronic device. Restricted content may include, but is not limited to, unauthorized applications, restricted videos, restricted images, restricted audio, restricted websites, or any combination thereof.
(15) In some embodiments, the timer may be further configured to notify the first API when the predetermined amount of time (during which the user has access to the restricted content) has elapsed. In some embodiments, upon notifying the first API that the predetermined amount of time has elapsed, the first API may be configured to initiate the transforming step described in the present disclosure below. In some embodiments the timer is a part of the Android™ API, an Apple™ Screentime API, or any combination thereof.
(16) Embodiments may also include downloading, to the internet enabled electronic device, from the remote source, the at least one enrichment program, which comprises the first API.
(17) Embodiments may also include manually preselecting a list of the restricted content, where the manually preselecting may be performed, via the first API, by a second user of the internet enabled electronic device. In some embodiments, the user may be a minor and the second user may be a parent or guardian. In other embodiments, this step of manually preselecting is done by the user looking to be incentivized to participate in the enriching experience in exchange for being granted access to the restricted content.
(18) Embodiments may also include transforming, via the first API, the internet enabled electronic device into a restricted state. As used herein, a “restricted state” is a state where the first API of the enrichment program coupled to the second API, in such a way that prevents the user from accessing the restricted content.
(19) In some embodiments, while coupled, the second API runs cohesively with the first API. In certain examples, the cohesion results in an alternate enrichment operating system where non-enriching components of the operating system are inaccessible.
(20) In some embodiments, the first API may be coupled to the second API upon the first API sending at least one lock instruction to the second API. In some embodiments, the at least one lock instruction commands the second API to prevent access to the restricted content.
(21) In some examples where the second API is a customized Android™ API In some such examples, the second API may comprise a custom service, where the custom service may be configured to lock all content other than at least one decoupled component. In some embodiments, the at least one decoupled component of the customized Android™ API in the restricted state. The at least one decoupled component, may, in some examples, comprise at least one enrichment program, a keypad of the internet enabled electronic device, or any combination thereof. In some examples, the at least one decoupled component of the customized Android™ API in the restricted state comprises at least one preauthorized mobile application, at least one browser displaying preauthorized content, or any combination thereof.
(22) Embodiments may also include obtaining a set of rules associated with the user, where the set of rules may include a preset enrichment quota and an enrichment count for the user, the enrichment count having no limit.
(23) Embodiments may also include generating, via the first API, the at least one enrichment program that can be played by the user to raise the enrichment count. Embodiments may also include applying the set of rules to determine whether the enrichment count may be lower than the preset enrichment quota. Embodiments may also include raising the enrichment count, upon completion of the at least one enrichment program.
(24) Embodiments may also include repeating the applying and raising until the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota.
(25) In some embodiments, once the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota, reverting, via the at least one unlock instruction, the internet enabled electronic device to the unrestricted state, such that the user may be granted access to the restricted content,

for the predetermined amount of time.
(26) In some embodiments, the method may include displaying a custom graphic when the user attempts to access restricted content when the enrichment count may be not greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota. In some embodiments, the custom graphic indicates that the restricted content may be locked.
(27) FIGS. **1** and **2** are flowcharts that describe a method, according to some embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, at **102**, the method may include obtaining a system described by the present disclosure.
(28) In some embodiments, at **104**, the method may include downloading, to the internet enabled electronic device, from the remote source, at least one enrichment program, where the at least one enrichment program comprises a first application programming interface (API), where the first API may be associated with the at least one enrichment program. In some embodiments, at **106**, the method may include manually preselecting a list of restricted content, where the manually preselecting may be performed, via the first API, by the user of the internet enabled electronic device. At **108**, the method may include transforming, via the first API, the internet enabled electronic device into a restricted state, such that the user may be prevented from accessing the restricted content.
(29) In some embodiments, at **110**, the method may include obtaining a set of rules associated with the user, where the set of rules comprises a preset enrichment quota and an enrichment count for the user, the enrichment count having no limit. At **112**, the method may include generating, via the first API, the at least one enrichment program that can be played by the user to raise the enrichment count. At **114**, the method may include applying the set of rules to determine whether the enrichment count may be lower than the preset enrichment quota.
(30) In some embodiments, at **116**, the method may include raising the enrichment count, upon completion of the at least one enrichment program. At **118**, the method may include repeating the applying and raising until the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota. At **120**, the method may include, once the enrichment count may be greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota, reverting, via the at least one unlock instruction, the internet enabled electronic device to the unrestricted state, such that the user may be granted access to the restricted content, for the predetermined amount of time.
(31) Various additional embodiments are contemplated by the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the enrichment program is provided by a remote source such as a third party or an advertising partner. In some embodiments, users can participate in additional enrichment programs beyond what is required to bring the internet enabled electronic device into an unrestricted state. In these embodiments, a user is provided with a register containing a list of tangible, physical items, each item having a respective item value, which can be earned and then subsequently shipped to the user upon redemption. In these embodiments, one or more rules are set to create a ratio of the item value to an amount of enrichment programs needed to be completed in order to have earned certain items. A user interface will be presented to allow the users to redeem these tangible, physical items.
(32) The description and drawings described herein represent example configurations and do not represent all the implementations within the scope of the claims. For example, the operations and steps may be rearranged, combined or otherwise modified. Also, structures and devices may be represented in the form of block diagrams to represent the relationship between components and avoid obscuring the described concepts Similar components or features may have the same name but may have different reference numbers corresponding to different figures.
(33) Some modifications to the disclosure may be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the principles defined herein may be applied to other variations without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Thus, the disclosure is not limited to the examples and designs described herein, but is to be accorded the broadest scope consistent with the principles and novel features disclosed

herein. Among those benefits and improvements that have been disclosed, other objects and advantages of this disclosure will become apparent from the following description taken in conjunction with the accompanying figures. Detailed embodiments of the present disclosure are disclosed herein; however, it is to be understood that the disclosed embodiments are merely illustrative of the disclosure that may be embodied in various forms. In addition, each of the examples given regarding the various embodiments of the disclosure which are intended to be illustrative, and not restrictive.
(34) In this disclosure and the following claims, the word “or” indicates an inclusive list such that, for example, the list of X, Y, or Z means X or Y or Z or XY or XZ or YZ or XYZ. Also the phrase “based on” is not used to represent a closed set of conditions. For example, a step that is described as “based on condition A” may be based on both condition A and condition B. In other words, the phrase “based on” shall be construed to mean “based at least in part on.” Also, the words “a” or “an” indicate “at least one.”
(35) Throughout the specification and claims, the following terms take the meanings explicitly associated herein, unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. The phrases “in one embodiment,” “in an embodiment,” and “in some embodiments” as used herein do not necessarily refer to the same embodiment(s), though it may. Furthermore, the phrases “in another embodiment” and “in some other embodiments” as used herein do not necessarily refer to a different embodiment, although it may. All embodiments of the disclosure are intended to be combinable without departing from the scope or spirit of the disclosure.
(36) As used herein, the term “based on” is not exclusive and allows for being based on additional factors not described, unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. In addition, throughout the specification, the meaning of “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references. The meaning of “in” includes “in” and “on.”
(37) All prior patents, publications, and test methods referenced herein are incorporated by reference in their entireties.
(38) Variations, modifications and alterations to embodiments of the present disclosure described above will make themselves apparent to those skilled in the art. All such variations, modifications, alterations and the like are intended to fall within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, limited solely by the appended claims.
(39) Any feature or element that is positively identified in this description may also be specifically excluded as a feature or element of an embodiment of the present as defined in the claims.
(40) As used herein, the term “consisting essentially of” limits the scope of a specific claim to the specified materials or steps and those that do not materially affect the basic and novel characteristic or characteristics of the specific claim.
(41) The disclosure described herein may be practiced in the absence of any element or elements, limitation or limitations, which is not specifically disclosed herein. Thus, for example, in each instance herein, any of the terms “comprising,” “consisting essentially of and “consisting of” may be replaced with either of the other two terms. The terms and expressions which have been employed are used as terms of description and not of limitation, and there is no intention in the use of such terms and expressions of excluding any equivalents of the features shown and described or portions thereof, but it is recognized that various modifications are possible within the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A method comprising: downloading, to an internet enabled electronic device, from a remote source, at least one enriching program and a restriction mediation module, wherein the restriction mediation module is configured to transform the internet enabled electronic device between a restricted state and an unrestricted state by sending a lock instruction and an unlock instruction,

respectively, to an operating system installed on the internet enabled electronic device; manually preselecting a list of restricted content, by a user of the internet enabled electronic device using the internet enabled electronic device to manually select among at least applications, videos, images, or audio, where the restricted content is content that is ordinarily accessible by the user of the internet enabled electronic device; initiating a transformation, by a user utilizing the restriction mediation module, of the internet enabled electronic device into a restricted state, comprising: selecting at least one enriching experience, embodied by the enriching program, to be performed by the user, wherein the at least one enriching experience is selected from the group consisting essentially of: running, walking, biking, swimming, jumping rope, hiking, dancing, taking a Pilates class, strength training, weight training, yoga, meditation, following a meal plan, tracking exercise, bible study, cooking, meal preparation, engaging with the community, journaling, drawing, learning an instrument, photography, sewing, painting, cleaning, managing finances, traveling, teaching others, volunteering, and engaging with a pet or other animal, obtaining a set of rules associated with the user, where the set of rules comprises a preset enrichment quota and an enrichment count for the user, the enrichment count having no limit, transforming the internet enabled electronic device to the restricted state, whereby the list of restricted content is not accessible to the user; generating, by the internet enabled electronic device the at least one enriching experience; raising the enrichment count, upon completion of the at least one enriching experience; repeating the generating and raising until the enrichment count is greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota; and once the enrichment count is greater than or equal to the preset enrichment quota, transforming, via an unlock instruction sent from the restriction mediation module, the internet enabled electronic device to the unrestricted state, such that the user is granted access to the restricted content, for a predetermined amount of time.
2. The method of claim 1, where the at least one enriching experience comprises a timer, where the timer is configured to measure the predetermined amount of time when the user is granted access to the restricted content.
3. The method of claim 2, where the remote source comprises at least one server computer, where the internet enabled electronic device is a client device of the at least one server computer.
4. The method of claim 3, where the internet enabled electronic device comprises a smartphone, a tablet, a gaming device, a desktop computer, a laptop computer, or any combination thereof.
5. The method of claim 4, further comprising the steps of: providing a register of a plurality of physical items, each physical item having a respective item value; and defining a ratio of enrichment count to the item value for each of the plurality of physical items.
6. The method of claim 5, further comprising the steps of: reducing the enrichment count by an amount corresponding to the total item values of one or more of the physical items based on the ratios for the one or more physical items; and providing to the user, the one or more physical items.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein each physical item is provided exclusively by one or more third parties.